FRC #12148
Team V.A.N. (Very Awesome Name)

A new community FIRST Robotics Competition team based in southern Brevard and northern Indian River for high school students

2026-2027

Investment Packet

Help Build the Next Generation of Space Coast Innovators

website: www.teamvan.org / email: contact@teamvan.org

"In the V.A.N., we brake for no one."



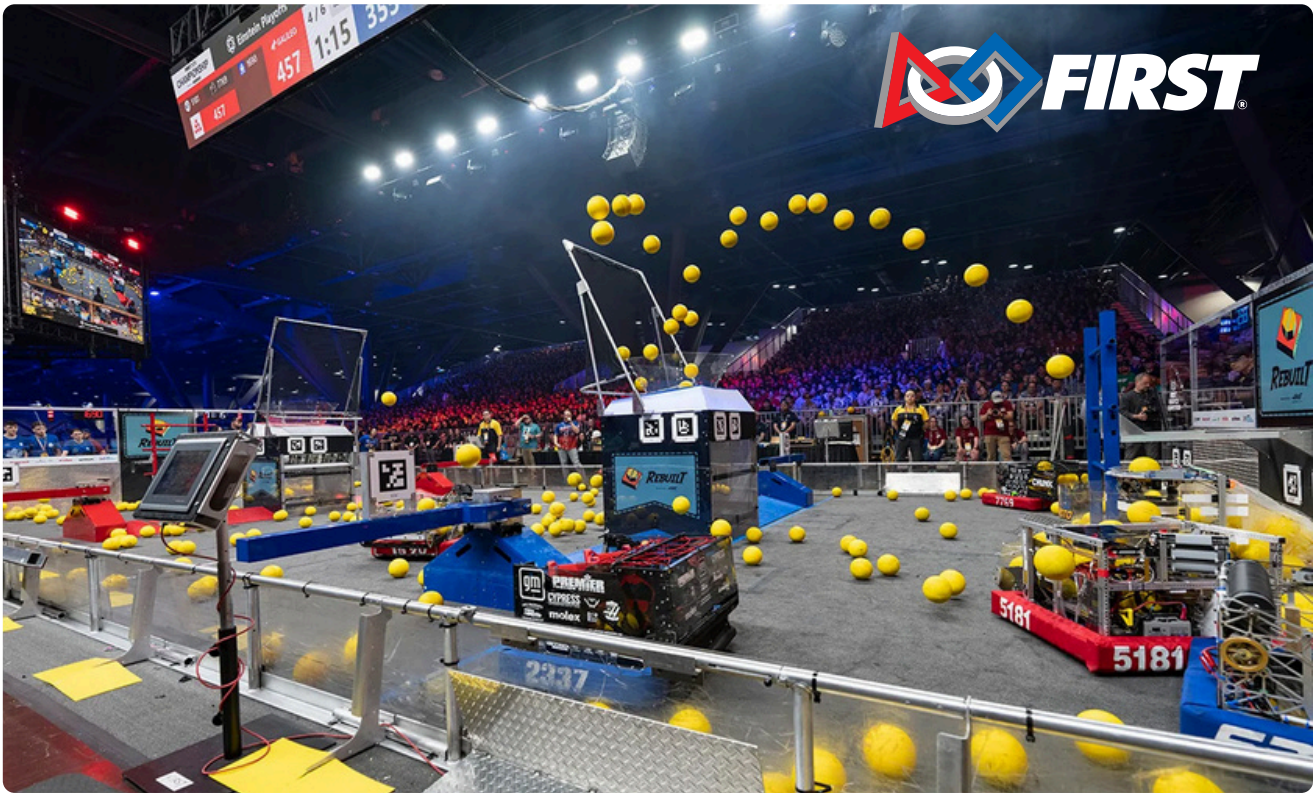
We are VAN

Team V.A.N.is a brand new robotics competition team founded to give local students a path into Space Coast industries. We are inspired by the future, technology, speed, and F1 Racing. Our team motto is “We brake for no one!”

We believe students should be able to discover engineering through hands-on experience and a positive, high-quality STEM education.

Students on our team will tackle real design challenges as they learn to build, program, test, troubleshoot, and improve a competition robot together.

Just as importantly, students will develop communication, leadership, project management, and problem-solving skills that carry far beyond the workshop.



What is FIRST Robotics?

FIRST **(For Inspiration and Recognition of Science and Technology)** is the world's leading non-profit organization for youth robotics and STEM education.

FIRST offers hands-on learning through creating robots that compete on the local, regional, state, and potentially international stage!

Programs run from K–12th grade, with opportunities for to learn both soft and technical skills at a every age.

FIRST highly prioritizes workforce education. Students learn about mechanical, electrical, software, and business aspects from a variety of skilled volunteer mentors.

Where does Team V.A.N. fit?

***FIRST* Robotics Competition (FRC)** is the high school program, which follows this Season Timeline:

Season Kickoff
JANUARY
> New Game Introduced (changes every year)
> Teams receive their official "Kit of Parts"

Next 6–8 Weeks
JAN–MARCH
> The time students are given to design, build, program, test & prep robot for competition

Competition Season
MARCH–MAY
> Head-to-head matches at Regional & District events
> Attempt to qualify for World Championships

The Gap We Fill

Our region has had a significant access gap...

For many students in southernmost Brevard and northern Indian River county, the nearest competitive robotics team was 40+ minutes away.

This means long commutes, high financial commitment, and demanding schedules that were difficult to maintain.

Those barriers often turn away motivated students before they are able to experience competitive robotics!

Your support will change students' futures...

By supporting Team V.A.N., you are building opportunity rooted in the communities students already call home.

Having a nearby team means students once unable to participate in competitive robotics can learn skills that directly align with workforce readiness and Career and Technical (CTE) education.

STEM Education Impact



Mentoring Young Robotics Students

GRADES K–8: *FIRST* LEGO League (FLL)
GRADES 7–12: *FIRST* Tech Challenge (FTC)

We help students explore robotics, develop technical skills, and build confidence through hands-on learning. We volunteer at competitions, fulfilling core roles such as referees and judges to ensure events run smoothly.



Expanding Robotics through Boy Scouts Outreach

By partnering with the Mind Forge Guild, a registered merit badge counselor, Team V.A.N. plans to teach robotics lessons to local Boy Scouts troops. Through workshops, we help a broader community learn about *FIRST* while receiving their Robotics Merit Badge.

Community & Advocacy



Local Tours

At Space Coast Showdown, Team V.A.N. provided guided tours for community leaders, educational advocates, and industry professionals to demonstrate the impact of FIRST Robotics Competition (FRC).



Future Plans

We will continue advocating for more STEM opportunities in Southern Brevard and Northern Indian River County. With our unique position as the only nearby community FRC team, we will use our voices to expand competitive robotics to all age groups and the Greater Central Florida Region.

Team Goals

Expand Access

> Serve multiple Title I and low-resource schools where extracurricular opportunities may be limited

> Be a community team that unites homeschool and traditional students

> Provide access to competitive robotics program that might otherwise be out of reach

Lower the Cost for Students

> We believe participation should be determined by curiosity, merit, and a willingness to learn—not financial circumstances

> Make FRC accessible to all students

> Keep student costs affordable

> Use grants, sponsorships, & in-kind donations to minimize financial barriers

Go Beyond Robot Competitions

> We are committed to strengthening community STEM education through outreach, mentorship, and inclusive collaboration

> We will inspire younger students

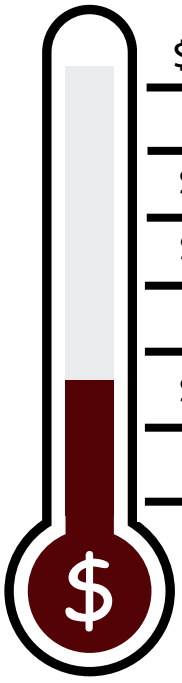
> We will cultivate a supportive team environment

> We will empower students to become confident problem-solvers and future innovators

> We are creating the next generation of mentors who will expand access to STEM for those who follow

Budget Summary & Urgency

ITEM	COST
Start-up, OPS & Reserve	$5,310
Robot & robot suppport	$9,458
Pit & Tool	$6,624
Shop	$9,265
Arena & Practice elements	$4,166
Regional 1 (local)	$7,999
Regional 2 (travel)	$17,600
TOTAL	$60,422



$60,422 by **3/29**

$49,322 by **3/1**

$44,523 by **1/23**

$35,668 by **1/14**

$25,968 by **1/9**

$9,828 by **11/30**

$7,018 by **11/7**

Investment Tiers

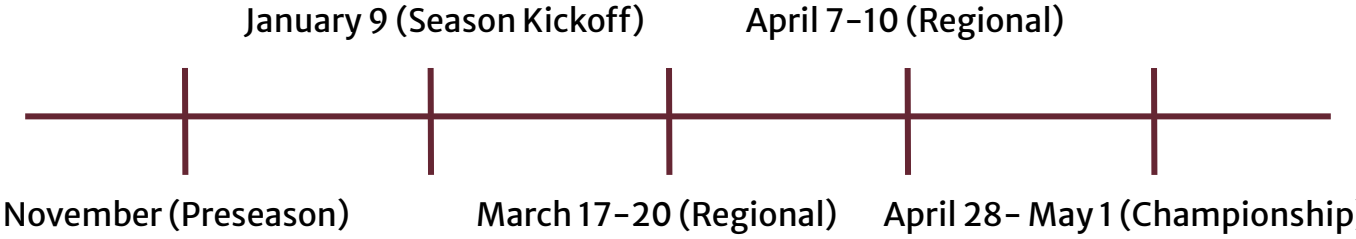
These tiers are **guidelines**. Contact us if you want to change or add anything.

SUPPORTLEVELS & BENEFITS	Bronze up to $500	Silver $500–$2,499	Gold $2,500–$4,999	Platinum $5,000–$9,999	Diamond $10,000+
Thank You Email and Website Recognition	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Recognition on Social Media	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Team V.A.N. Shirt(s)		1	2	3	5
Postcard of Appreciation		✓	✓	✓	✓
Monthly Investor Newsletter			✓	✓	✓
Your Logo on Robot, Team Banner, & Team Shirt			**Small**	**Medium**	**Large**
Robot Demos for Your Company			✓	✓	✓
Tour of our Shop/Buildspace				✓	✓
Primary Recognition on Our Social Media, Website, and Robot					✓

Other Ways to Help

We gladly accept donations that are applicable to our needs, as our robot needs very specific items to comply with *FIRST* rules. If you are interested in donating a specific item, please reach out to the team so we can match your gift to the most immediately needed relevant item and ensure a match within the investment tier level.

Competition Timeline



Thank You!

Donation Tax Receipt

Please complete this form and keep for your tax records

Date: _____ Donation from: ☐ Individual ☐ Organization

Organization/Company Name: _____

Donor Name: _____

Address: _____

City: _____ State: _____ Zip: _____

Phone: _____ E-mail: _____

Donation Information

Please provide all necessary information via brief descriptions:

THE MINDFORGE GUILD INC
2475 Palm Bay Rd NE Suite 210, Palm Bay, FL 32905
EIN 42-4874614 · FL Solicitation Reg. #CH85609

DONATION RECEIPT — Designated for Team V.A.N. (FRC 12148)
Sponsor Level: _____
Amount: $_____
[or] Description of goods donated: _____

No goods or services were provided in exchange for this contribution. Receipts are issued by **The MindForge Guild Inc** (Team V.A.N. is not a separate legal entity — the Guild is the 501(c)(3) receiving the gift).

Thank you for supporting Team V.A.N. (FRC 12148)!